Quotes for Essays

28/07/25

Essay Topic (UPSE CSE 2015) –

"Lending Hands to someone is better than giving a dole"

dole → benefit paid by the State to the unemployed.

Quotes related to this –

1. "Give a man a fish, and you feed him for a day. Teach a man to fish, and you feed him for a lifetime"
   – Chinese Proverb

2. Vedic teachings – "Sarve bhavantu sukhinah" and Bhagwad gita emphasis on Karma yoga.

3. Mahatma Gandhi → Swaraj → Not just political freedom but self reliance through constructive works like khadi, sanitation and village industries.

4. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar → Emphasized empowerment through education not appeasement through handouts.

Difference between Dole and lending a hand –

Aspect	Dole (Free - assistance)	Lending a hand (Empowerment)
Nature	Passive, Short-term	Active, Long-term
Psycological Impact	Can breed dependency, loss of dignity	Builds self esteem and capability
Economic Effect	Often insustainable	promotes productivity and growth
Example	Free ration without livelihood training	MGNREGA (Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act), 2005 Aligning work with skill development

Other Empowerment based schemes -

1. Skill - India Mission - Building employability
2. Stand-up India, Start-up India - promoting Entrepreneurship

3. Ujjwala yojana - replacing subsidies with direct benefit transfer.
4. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen kaushal Yojana - skilling rural youth

Real-time examples -

1. Sulabh International - Dr. Bindeshwar pathak enabled manual scavengers to become entrepreneurs in sanitation.
2. Amul - Empowered rural women through cooperative models instead of one-time grants.
3. SEWA (Self-Employed Women's Association) - led by Ela Bhatt, helped thousand of women earn livelihood through training, not aid.

More Quotes -

1. "True charity is empowering others to live with dignity." - Nelson Mandela
2. "You cannot help men permanently by doing for them what they could and should do for themselves." Abraham

Lincoln

3. "Welfare without work is a sin against humanity." - Mahatma Gandhi

Conclusion -

India's vision of Antyodaya - uplifting the last person is not about charity, but about dignity.

Helping others means walking with them not throwing coins at them from a pedestal.

In the words of Rig-veda -

"Let us walk together, speak together and understand each other's minds."

That is true empowerment - not giving a dole but giving a direction.